



Individual Instructor Report Spring 2023 Version A for STA 301 - INTRO TO DATA SCIENCE-WB (05255) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Instructor Course Evaluations Spring 2023**

Courses Audience: **46**

Responses Received: **16**

Response Ratio: **34.8%**

Report Comments

Results were collected during the implementation of a new course evaluation system.

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

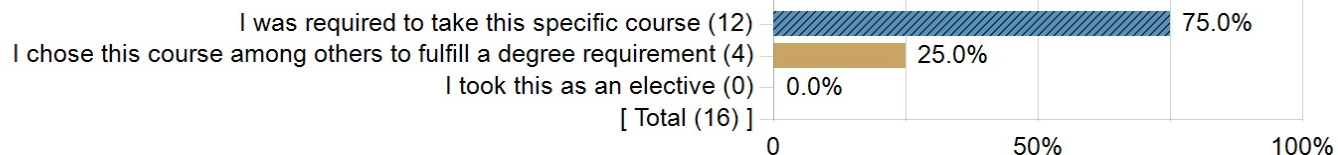
The number of students (e.g. Respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no one method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

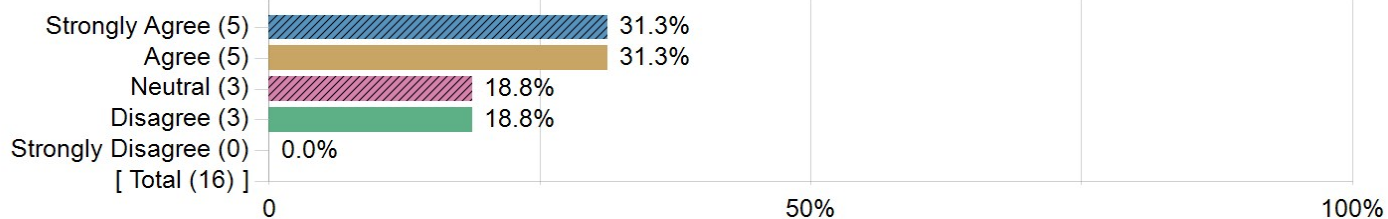
Creation Date: **Friday, June 16, 2023**

Course Questions

Why did you take this course?



During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.



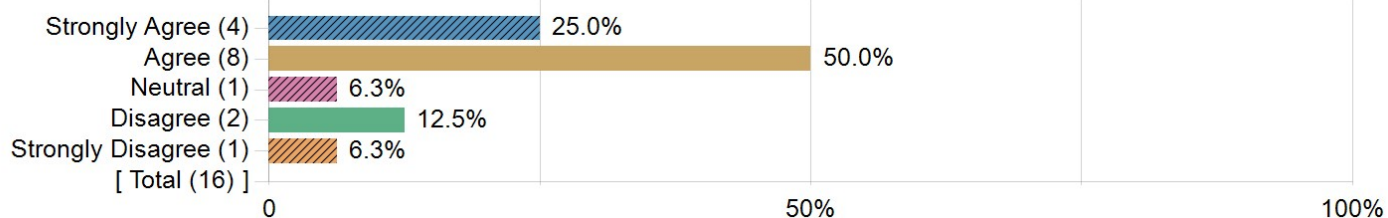
Statistics

Value

Mean

3.75

The course was well organized.



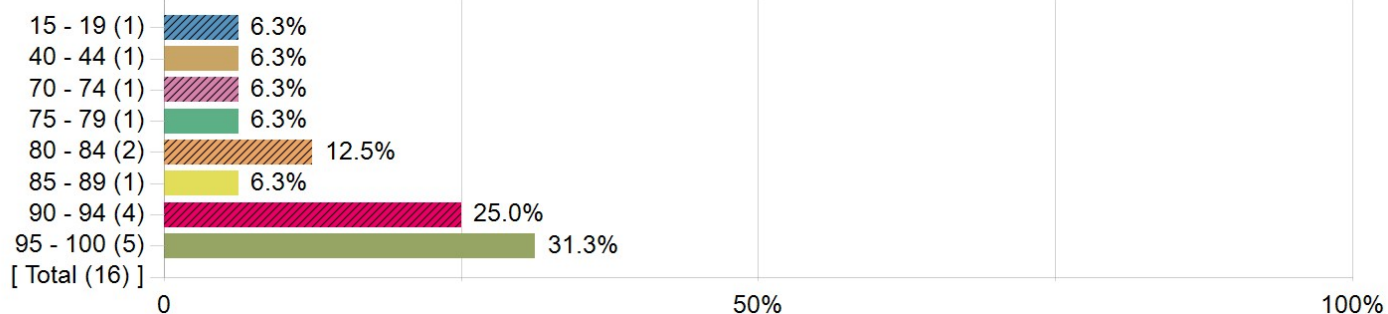
Statistics

Value

Mean

3.75

Overall, approximately what percentage of the course meetings did you attend or complete (online, in person, or asynchronously)?



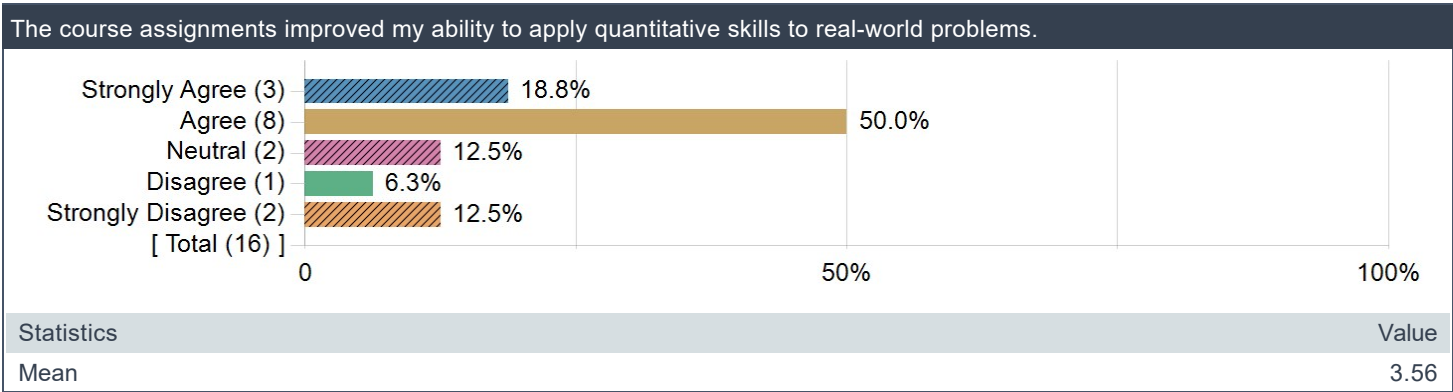
Statistics

Value

Mean

81.31

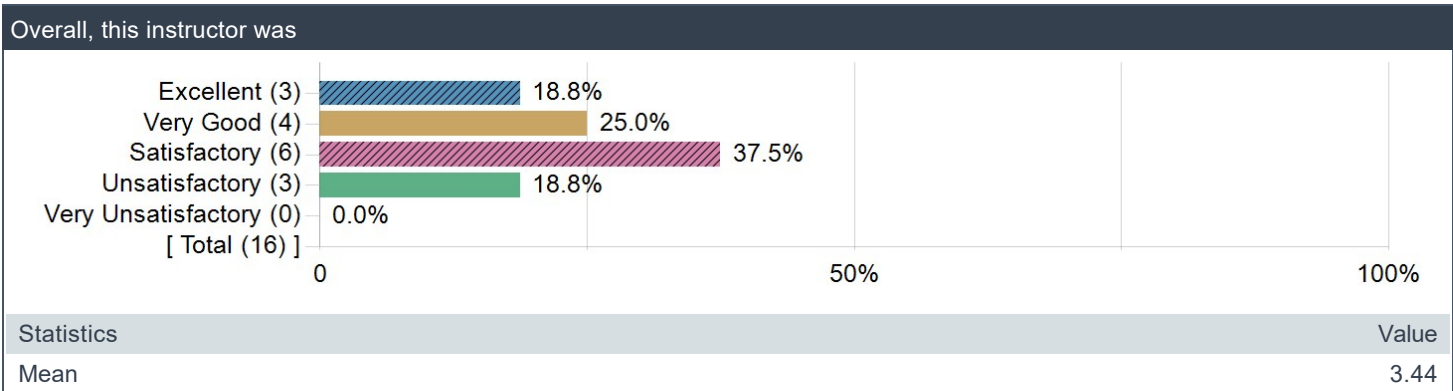
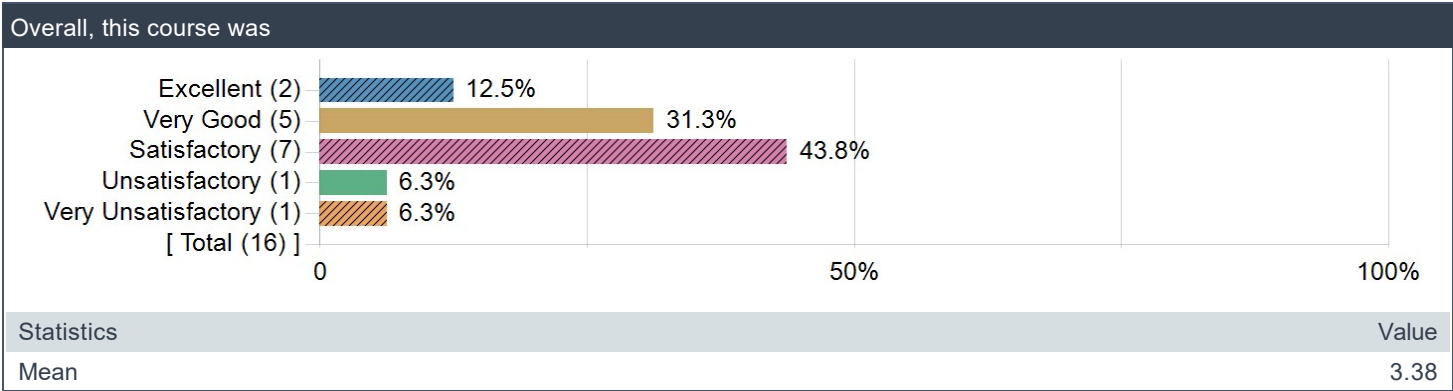
The course assignments improved my ability to apply quantitative skills to real-world problems. (Flag Question)



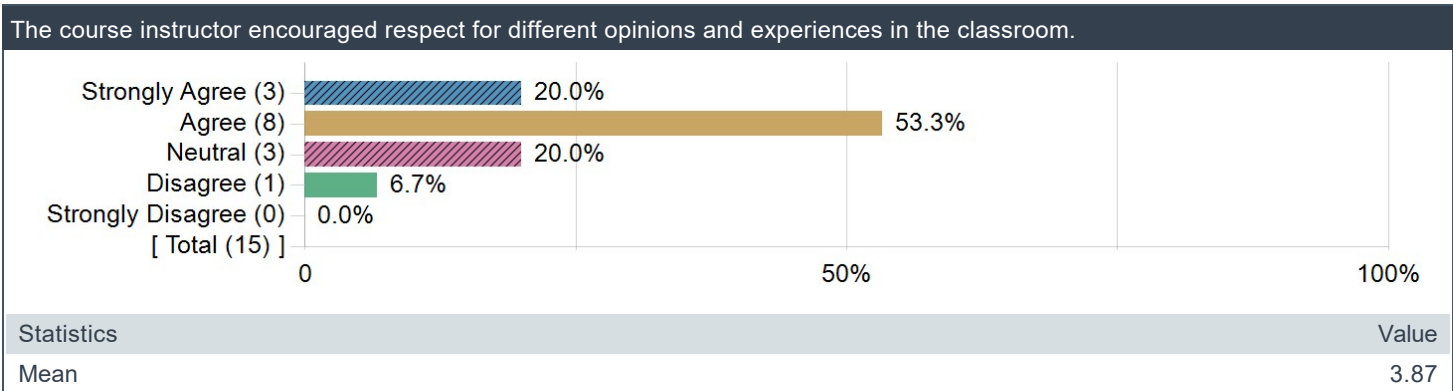
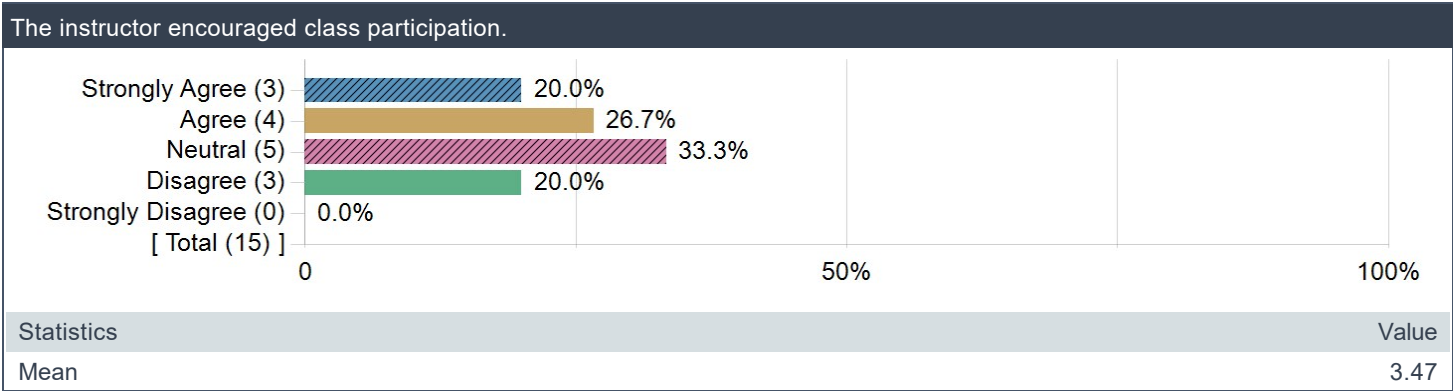
Instructor Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	25.0%	31.3%	25.0%	18.8%	0.0%	16	3.63
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	31.3%	37.5%	25.0%	6.3%	0.0%	16	3.94
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	25.0%	43.8%	6.3%	12.5%	12.5%	16	3.56
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	12.5%	25.0%	18.8%	31.3%	12.5%	16	2.94
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	18.8%	50.0%	6.3%	18.8%	6.3%	16	3.56

Overall Questions



College, School, or Unit Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
The knowledge checks were a nice way to keep up with the material.
Great explanations and walkthroughs!
Showing us how to do R was at least kind of helpful.
By the end of the course we were spending much more time coding rather than going through the slides which was preferable.
Following along on R during lectures
I think the vast amount of TA office hours was helpful for students, as there are so many available times for students to answer questions they may have.
The lectures during zoom
The professor answering questions and making sure each student understands on zoom.
The KC's
knowledge checks
I think going over coding exercises in class helped a lot.

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
The lectures in this class felt useless. I tried to attend some at the beginning, but quickly learned that they did not add to my understanding. Reading the textbook along with the knowledge checks were a perfectly fine way to learn this class. An asynchronous version of this course with just knowledge checks and homework, with maybe some videos on showing certain more difficult topics for those that need it would be perfectly acceptable for this course.
The course was taught well!
Soooo much coding that must be learned. I don't understand why this is so critical to the degree. I wish it was more based on the conceptual stats ideas.
Making the lectures more succinct would be helpful, particularly spending less time on the slides.
Homework assignments are challenging because they take a long time and require many different skills.
The most difficult thing in this class for me was the exams, I found the time allowed to take the exam to be very challenging. You need to be able to answer the questions pretty quickly, I would suggest students take thorough notes during the lessons so that they have something to refer back to in case they forget something during the exam.
Moving the final to inperson on short notice.
Having to use R and user error.
The homework, I feel like we should get more lenience
the homeworks because they were long and challenging
I think data wrangling was the most confusing.